



BRAHMA CHELLANEY



China thinks that India doesn't have the political or military will to resist an attack. They have some advantages, so I would not minimise the danger.

What we have seen now shows that the spectre of a Sino-Indian cold war is looming large.

I fear it is not by design that the Chinese want to teach India a lesson. Events are going to escalate and there will be a danger of limited war.

When the President of the world's most powerful country chooses not to meet the Dalai Lama, when he visits Washington D.C., it emboldens Beijing to step up pressure on the country that is providing a haven to him.

SATISH NAMBIAR

It is important for India to allow the visit of the Dalai Lama to Arunachal Pradesh.

China has been uncomfortable with India's Tibet policy. But in the past year they have developed an insecurity with the uprising in Tibet and Xinjiang and with the labour unrest in its many provinces.



We have a great capacity for the rhetoric but we only talk because many of the things like the intrusions in Ladakh have been happening for years.

During the 60th anniversary parade, China's paranoid security was unimaginable. Their actions reveal that they are worried.

state powers of the two countries before India catches up. They probably would not like to go for a military engagement but they like to be the bully. There shouldn't be hysteria or media hype, but substantive things should be done. We should be prepared by building our capacity very fast. Procurement in defence acquisition and their induction takes lot of time, so I think this should be accelerated, with not so much Pakistan in mind but with the focus on China.

Kapil Kak: Until 2008, China knew how to handle India, a second-rate power which was nowhere in the game until now. The Chinese media have rattled them by stories on Indo-US proximity and that is the root of their fears. But what has brought this dilemma forth is the fact that this is happening when China is still growing, so India becomes a very easy target in terms of giving it some territorial concessions. What did we do when the ambassador on the eve of President Hu Jintao's visit said Arunachal Pradesh is part of China? If our reactions are so soft I am afraid their responses are going to be harder.

If you are looking at the manner in which the force would be applied, it is very unlikely that they will repeat 1962. They cannot and will not succeed. The White Paper of 2004 and 2008 talk of air and maritime dominance and causing strategic paralysis. In such an asymmetric war you have to be very concerned. I want to add that there is a huge capacity buildup in cyber warfare. This is where they have invested a lot. I am glad that we too have progressed in this over the last five years. In terms of military capability, we have employed a lot of divisions in Tibet. China's ability is a bit too hyped. It requires two Sukhoi 30s to break up China's famous permanent frost Lhasa railway line. They would not be able to move anything by even five feet on the line as it will be completely destroyed. Militarily we need to be more circumspect in evaluating what they can do. We must allow the Dalai Lama's visit to Tawang.